

Estimation Appendix

1. Scope Estimated

We calculated the AI chatbot and tailored financial advice. These tools aid users in understanding their financial situation, cutting back on wasteful spending, and boosting savings. This estimate does not include the full app, it only includes these AI features.

2. Methods Used

Use-Case Points: Two use cases—financial inquiries and suggestions—as well as one user actor counted. This resulted in 23 use-case points. The estimate is $23 \times 20 = 460$ team hours, assuming a rate of 20 hours per point. Environmental and technical factors were both taken to be 1.0.

Analogous Estimation: Copilot Money and our slices were compared. 36 person-months are obtained by using a two-person team and an assumed 18 months. We used 160 hours per person-month, if our slice represents 10–15% of that effort: $36 \times 0.10 \times 160 = 576$ hours and $36 \times 0.15 \times 160 = 864$ hours. There was no change made to the team size.

3. Estimated Range

Total Effort	460-864 team hours
Expected Effort	654 team hours
Cost at an assumed \$60/hour	\$27,600-\$51,840
Expected duration	About 5.5 weeks

Expected effort uses a most likely value of 650 hours: $(460 + 4 \times 650 + 864) \div 6 = 654$ hours. With four people each working an assumed 30 productive hours per week, duration is $654 \div (4 \times 30) = 5.45$ weeks.

4. Reasoning and Assumptions

One approach uses a similar product, while the other counts our user goals. The most likely estimate of 650 hours accounts for potential additional complexity in AI integration, testing, and personalization. All productivity numbers and rates are based on planning assumptions. The 18-month duration of Copilot has not been confirmed, and confirmation is still required for the AI service actors and integration effort. The cost table does not include separate hosting and API usage fees.